

Quick Start Guide

StationFinder

Overview

StationFinder is a browser-based frequency management tool for shortwave listeners and SDR enthusiasts. It works with frequency databases (EiBi, Aoki, HFCC, ILG, and others) and connects to your SDR receiver to enable real-time tuning, monitoring, and signal scanning.

NOTE

StationFinder runs on Windows 11 and has been reported to work well on macOS and Linux. It requires only a Chromium-based browser such as Microsoft Edge or Google Chrome. Firefox and Safari are not supported due to API restrictions.

Installation

StationFinder does not require installation and makes no registry changes.

- Unzip the program into a directory of your choice.
- Read the README file for a full description of features.
- Double-click StationFinder_v3.0.html to open it. If your default browser is not Edge or Chrome, open the file manually in a Chromium-based browser.
- Click the Help button at any time for descriptions of function buttons, shortcut keys, and access to the ListBuilder program.

Loading a Frequency File

The first step is to import a frequency database file.

- Click the Import File button. A file picker will open.
- Navigate to the Frequency Schedules folder inside the directory where you unzipped StationFinder.
- Choose one of eight sub-folders and select a file to import.

Folder	Description
Aoki	Aoki frequency schedule
EiBi	EiBi frequency schedule

Folder	Description
HFCC	HFCC frequency schedule
s wskeds	Merged EiBi, Aoki & HFCC file
ILG	ILG Radio (includes a sample file for 11650–11750 kHz)
s1b	SDRplay file format
SDR Console	Frequency database converted to CSV format
Merged	Merged file created using ListBuilder

If the file imported correctly, the “No file loaded” message changes to “Loaded · 1000 rows” (or the actual row count). Navigation buttons beside this label allow you to move through the file 1000 rows at a time — this is Page mode.

Searching & Filtering

Frequency Search

- Enter a frequency in kHz in the Search (Frequency) box and press Enter to display all stations on that frequency.
- Press Esc while in the frequency search box to return to Page mode.
- Press the Range button to set the frequency range to ± 150 kHz around the entered frequency — useful for finding other stations in the same band. You can also type any custom range followed by Enter; note that larger ranges take longer to render.

On Air & Filters

- Press On Now to show only stations with scheduled broadcasts currently on-air.
- Use the Mode drop-down to filter by demodulation mode.
- Use the Language drop-down to filter by broadcast language.
- Use the Search (Station) box to filter by station name. StationFinder searches anywhere within the Station name field.

Connecting to Your SDR

StationFinder supports three connection methods. Select the appropriate method from the drop-down menu and press Connect.

Connection Type	Description
WebSocket	Connects to SDRconnect on the same computer, across a LAN, or

Connection Type	Description
	over the Internet. The default IP and port are pre-configured for local use.
CAT (COM port)	Virtual COM port connection using the Kenwood protocol. Compatible with SDRconnect, SDRUno, SDR Console V3, and HDSDR. Default baud rate is 9600.
CAT (Icom rig)	Icom CI-V serial connection. Select the baud rate and CI-V address for your rig (consult your rig manual or search online for your model).

The Connected icon turns green when a connection is established successfully.

WebSocket — Additional Setup

- Same computer: default IP and port are pre-set. Select WebSocket and press Connect.
- LAN (another computer): SDRconnect must be run with elevated privileges. On Windows 11, right-click the SDRconnect icon and select Run as Administrator, then enter the IP address of the computer running SDRconnect.
- Remote / Internet: elevated privileges are required as above, and your router must be configured to forward port 5454 to the LAN IP address where SDRconnect is running.

NOTE Instructions for SDRUno CAT setup are included in the StationFinder release package.

SDR Control Features

Once a WebSocket or CAT connection is active, the following controls become available.

Button / Action	What It Does
Fetch	Retrieves the current SDR VFO frequency once (one-time action).
Track	Continuously follows the SDR VFO frequency and performs automatic table updates within a few milliseconds.
Manual	Enables manual frequency input for searches.
Web Search 1 / 2	Opens a new browser tab with additional information based on the current VFO frequency.
Click a row	Sends the frequency and mode (if available) to the SDR program.
Ctrl + click a row	Displays a detail panel with neatly arranged table information and options to search on specific parameters. When using a non-merged ILG file, additional information is available — try it with the sample ILG file at 11700 kHz.

Step, Hop & Scan

Step, Hop, and Scan were added in StationFinder version 3.0. These features provide three complementary ways to navigate a loaded frequency list and are available when the search mode is set to Range.

Feature	What It Does
Step	Manually step through frequencies in the table one at a time, forward or backward.
Hop	Automatically cycle through all frequencies with a configurable dwell time between each.
Scan	Sweep the SDR across a frequency range and detect active stations using FFT signal analysis (WebSocket / SDRconnect only).

TIP

A separate User Guide describing Step, Hop, and Scan in detail is located in the documentation folder of the release package.

ListBuilder

ListBuilder is a companion program for downloading, converting, saving, and merging frequency list files. Like StationFinder, it requires a Chromium-based browser.

- ListBuilder is included in the unzipped release folder or can be opened from the link at the bottom of the Help file.
- It eliminates the need to manually unzip frequency files — both ListBuilder and StationFinder can import compressed files directly.
- Instructions for each frequency list source are provided within the program.